

Kyle Brief

27 March 2026 strategy call summary and immediate executive decisions

PREPARED FOR INTERNAL ALIGNMENT AND PARTNER-READY PRESENTATION

Mycology Publishing Project

Prepared 28 March 2026 | Digest format for rapid internal handoff

DOCUMENT NOTE

This brief distills the call into what changed, what was decided, what remains unresolved, and what Kyle should help decide next.

WHAT THE CALL DECIDED

The project is not one book waiting for formatting. It is a two-track publishing program that now needs gated execution.

The manuscript itself was not rejected for weak substance. The issue identified in the call was a mismatch between the current manuscript form and the audience it was supposed to serve.

CORE CONCLUSION

The science is strong, but the current manuscript reads too much like a scientific paper for the broader grower audience it was originally meant to reach.

NEW PRODUCT MODEL

Split the project into a visual-forward physical specialty edition and a fuller digital/reference edition.

CRITICAL DEPENDENCY

David Carlson's existing illustrations are not decorative extras; they are likely the visual spine of the specialty edition.

LIKELY TIMING

The realistic publication horizon discussed on the call was next spring rather than an immediate release.

WHY THIS MATTERS

What Kyle should understand immediately

- The original concept was educational: explain fungi–cannabis interactions to growers and farmers without a scientific background. During drafting, the writing drifted into scientific-paper density.
- The call's main strategic correction was to stop treating the problem as “format the book” and instead treat it as “define what each edition is meant to do.”
- The physical edition is meant to be a premium, browseable, image-led product for discovery, credibility, and conversation. The digital/reference edition is meant to preserve the project's full technical value for serious growers, educators, institutions, and researchers.

- The visual system matters commercially. Mixing unrelated art styles, stock imagery, or ad hoc AI art would weaken the authority of the specialty edition.
 - The call also surfaced that rights clarity, technical accessibility editing, and route-to-market discipline are ahead of typesetting in the execution sequence.
- WHAT NOT TO DO NEXT**

Do not jump straight into formatting. Do not begin publisher outreach before rights and positioning are clean. Do not mix visual styles without a deliberate art-direction plan.

IMMEDIATE NEXT ACTIONS

What the team should do in the next 7–14 days

Priority	Action	Why it matters
1	Approve the two-edition architecture and Book A first / Book B second sequencing.	Everything else depends on this. Artist outreach, editorial conversion, layout, and route selection all need the edition model locked first.
2	Collect and review every Carlson invoice, email, agreement, and website licensing reference.	The team likely has enough evidence to support commissioned use, but the exact scope for print, digital, exclusivity, and derivative use still needs to be verified.
3	Finalize and send the artist outreach email after internal alignment.	The artist conversation may shape art direction, cover treatment, additional illustrations, and cost.
4	Run a manuscript audit by section: keep, condense, cut, appendix, digital-only, diagram, or sidebar.	This is how the team converts a dense manuscript into two usable products without losing substance.
5	Resolve the publication path question as a primary route plus a fallback route.	The uploaded scorecard contains a recommendation/score tension that should be reconciled explicitly rather than left implicit.

DECISIONS KYLE SHOULD WEIGH IN ON

The call leaves four practical decisions in front of the team right now

Decision 1	Confirm that the two-edition model is now the governing strategy, rather than trying to force one book to serve every reader and use case.
Decision 2	Approve whether the first artist email should stay high-level on compensation or include budget specifics. Recommended posture: do not quote hard numbers in the first message unless there is already a defined ceiling and

	a need to surface it immediately.
Decision 3	Decide whether speed, control, prestige, or margin is the dominant tie-breaker when trade-offs emerge. This will affect the route-to-market choice.
Decision 4	Confirm how much appetite the team has for a grant-assisted path versus a faster specialty-publisher fallback.

RECOMMENDED IMMEDIATE APPROVALS

Approve the two-edition model, authorize artist outreach without hard budget numbers in the first email, and instruct the team to finish rights verification before broader publisher or partner outreach. Also note the route-score tension: the numeric scorecard favors Specialty Trade Publisher slightly, while the workbook recommendation sheet still prefers Grant-Assisted Hybrid for strategic reasons.

BOTTOM LINE

The manuscript is viable. The form is wrong. The call produced a workable plan: lock the edition model, verify art rights, engage the artist, translate the manuscript for accessibility without losing scientific integrity, then choose the publishing route by design rather than by urgency.

Source basis: 27 March 2026 strategy call transcript, project summary and prompt pack, edition architecture memo, artist outreach brief, rights inventory workbook, and publishing route scorecard workbook.